

Jun 27, 2026

Strvx Robotics Briefing — Kenneth Hinkle - Transcript

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Alex Battikha: Hey, Kenneth, could you hear us?

Kenneth Hinkle: I can.

Alex Battikha: Perfect. All right. Thank you so much for taking the time to meet with us today.

Kenneth Hinkle: Yeah. Not

Alex Battikha: Um, all right. So,

Kenneth Hinkle: so

Alex Battikha: yeah, just to kick this off and kind of a rough idea of this meeting. Um, we we don't want to go too long. We respect your time and we really value it. Um, we just want to give you a little bit of context behind what we do, um, and what we're trying to get out of this meeting. And then we had a few questions for you and potential, um, see if there's any overlap between us and we'll go from there.

Kenneth Hinkle: Okay, sounds

Alex Battikha: Um, all right. So, I'll I'll introduce myself.

Kenneth Hinkle: good.

Alex Battikha: I'm Alex. Um, I'm working with Nicholas. Uh, we we're co-founders of Strivex Robotics. So, what we do is um it's autonomous drones. Um, and it's for like monitoring, security, um, of like valuable assets or critical infrastructure.

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Alex Battikha: Um, and we're building like the sort of software intelligence layer. Um, we're based out of San Francisco and yeah, that's rough idea of

Kenneth Hinkle: Nice. Nice.

Alex Battikha: us.

Kenneth Hinkle: Yeah. Guys, before we start, I'm going to tell you, um, we we're dealing we're working with a guy, um, it's called Autonomo, and we just recently went over the the masters. We was trying to find a a solution. Uh, they were actually going to provide like a like a digital twin type thing where they were going to simulate um our traffic. So it kind of gives us better um um we can you know make better decisions based on historical and then current um uh current traffic. Uh and so when I got something from you guys it's like yeah it makes sense. Um to your question I don't want to take over the meeting but um you know currently we use uh our operation agents to um you know monitor the uh the runways. So um randomly the guys they go out and they check the the runways for inspect the runways and taxiways and of course even with the security side on the inside of the fence.

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Kenneth Hinkle: um our operation agents are doing that you know on um a daily basis and then also our marshals are checking the perimeter fence you know on timely but to have a bird's eye view uh of the uh the ramp uh and of those areas is is is awesome. So I'm that's why I'm looking forward to to your um to listen

Alex Battikha: Yeah, for sure. Okay. Yeah, it sounds like exactly like what we do and I see there's strong overlap. Um I I'm kind of curious. So, what is it like? Could you just walk me through what it looks like on ground right now? how many people would be out there. Um like what happens when something gets

Kenneth Hinkle: So what happens uh our um our operation agents they have daily

Alex Battikha: triggered

Kenneth Hinkle: tasks. So the first task is to check the runway before uh uh any commercial uh air airlines take off. So this like around 6:00 7:00. So they do their checks. um that's the really the primary thing they need to do.

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Kenneth Hinkle: Then um during the course of the day, they'll do checks on the runway. Um you know, if we have uh uh some u concrete issues or um a light or anything that that will violate our airport certification. Um, and so, uh, what'll happen if they find any issues or whatever, they record that or they send a work order up, um, for our maintenance team to, uh, repair. Uh, and so what we've done in the past, it was it was manual. Uh, this year, we've actually, um, we have a we have a program called Aeros Simple. And so, it identifies the different locations on the runway. So the guys can say, "Hey, we're using, you know, runway 826 and we have a rail that's out." Um, before they like go up and down the runway to see where this rail is. Now we can kind of pinpoint and say, "Hey, this is where it's at." Um, so basically what our operation team does is they're really the police of the um of the nonmovement movement area.

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Kenneth Hinkle: So, if they find any issues, discrepancies, or anything like that, they're going to report it. And then once they report it, then our maintenance team will go out and repair it. And then after they repair it, they'll go out and look at it again to see if it was actually repaired to their satisfaction. Um, and so we do that daily. Um,

Strvx Robotics: Okay.

Kenneth Hinkle: but go ahead.

Strvx Robotics: Okay. Just to kind of get an overview. So, you have people that go on the runway, they inspect, if they find an issue, they write up like a little work order and they float it up for maintenance or whoever to resolve at high high level.

Kenneth Hinkle: That's correct. Yes, sir.

Strvx Robotics: Okay. All

Kenneth Hinkle: I have always uh and then on the uh security side um they're they're not doing it like every hour.

Strvx Robotics: right.

Kenneth Hinkle: So it's like randomly like, "Hey, we got to do it in a security check." But if you had, you know, some autonomous drones, they're already over there.

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Kenneth Hinkle: They're it's covered. I mean, it's like a like a bird's eye view of, uh, of what's going on. Um, the challenge for you guys, um, normally airports are are no drone zones, you know. Um, and so you have to get over that. And then I just learned uh this this weekend that um you guys um you know if you work with the local aircraft control tower, you can get permission to to have work, you know, do work on the runways. Um, and then your company, uh, and that's I'm kind of envious of you guys because if it gets off the ground like it should be, um, not only, um, you know, Augusta Regional Airport, but I mean, it's it's going to be a lot of airports that are going to need that because right now, nobody's doing any autonomous drone flying to to monitor their um their airfield. Um, and then going forward, like I said, Masters, and I'm not sure if you guys are familiar with Masters, but it's a huge GA event where, you know, last in April, we had 4,200 operations.

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Kenneth Hinkle: So, I can't if I don't have a drone, I won't have a bird's eye view of what's going on. So, I actually have to go to each location. So, it would be awesome to look up on a computer and say, "Hey, there's my runway. There's all my airplanes that

are parked here." and I don't have to go I don't have to walk or drive or do anything. I know where everything is at. So, um yeah, you guys got a good uh good product.

Strvx Robotics: Yeah, thank you. Thank you. Yeah, that seems we is exactly what we do.

Kenneth Hinkle: So,

Strvx Robotics: So that's a good thing.

Alex Battikha: I'm kind of interested in hearing um what do you think is like the biggest bottleneck right now? Is it just man-hour? Like you needed like a ton of uh pe like men out there on ground to do these

Kenneth Hinkle: Yeah.

Alex Battikha: inspections?

Kenneth Hinkle: Yeah. So, the problem we have is they're they're needed, but they're not. So, it's like, hey, we need we need somebody to monitor the operation.

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Kenneth Hinkle: However, you know, you have to pay somebody um you know, 40 hours a week. Uh, and they're, you know, you're not inspecting the runway like every minute of the day. You're not you're not doing the inspection the entire day. It's just like you have some time to goof off. You have, you know, downtime. But if you if you had a a drone, it's constantly monitoring it, you know, like, hey, we got a run, we got a aircraft that's landing. Obviously, you want to get out of the way of that. But, um, a lot of times, um, we can't get on the runway because of, uh, traffic. Um, but if you already had a drone or something, you don't have to um you don't have to move. You know, you're there. If if you're if we're using our main runway, you could be uh inspecting the crosswind runway or vice versa. Uh so it gives a a better flexibility and and I guess better use of time. Um you know I guess initially we would integrate this with what we already have and then you know 10 years 20 years down the road it would really phase out an operation agent because you guys would be doing exactly you you would you would check for for deficiencies on the runway um and report that out.

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Kenneth Hinkle: So whatever that you know if you guys already have a reporting system or some kind of work order system that's exactly what what will happen

Strvx Robotics: Okay. So, yeah. So, for uh next steps, would you like us to give us some time to work up a demo for you to kind of see how it works,

Kenneth Hinkle: please

Strvx Robotics: see how it looks, and then from there we can move on to something more concrete?

Kenneth Hinkle: please please. Yeah.

Strvx Robotics: Okay, sounds

Kenneth Hinkle: So guys, so guys, yeah, demo. Um,

Strvx Robotics: good.

Kenneth Hinkle: you know, I would love for you guys to um if you're doing the the airfield monitoring, then have some kind of way that you could interface with our work order system, then it would be seamless. Like, you know, you guys the the the drone has found a crack in our, you know, in our touchdown zone or they, you know, they need to repaint this or they need to repaint that. it would automatically send that information out to our work order system and then then we're done.

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Kenneth Hinkle: You know, it's like now we might need to have an agent go back out and reinspect it, but for the most part, you know, you guys the the drone has done what what we asked for it. And then um this is just selfishness. um for our masters traffic uh we have an issue of you know kind of keeping track of the airplanes and and the conditions or whatever but to have a a drone like I call it a bird's eye kind of flying over the entire um field u is would be amazing. That's something that we that we don't have at this point. And if we can get um a drone company uh to come out uh that

would be awesome. Uh, last thing and I'll I'll shut up for today. What happens? I'm a geek when it comes to technology and um we're okay with being guinea pigs because I you know, Alex and guys, we we know you guys this is going to be the wave of the future. So, I'm glad that you kind of stepping out early on.

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Kenneth Hinkle: Uh so but what happens is um and I'll give you for instance we were working with Banamo and they said hey Ken it's going to be \$50,000 to do this. H we're not going to be able to pay \$50,000 for the for the service. What we can do is just do \$25,000. It's like okay well since it's the first year we did it. So hey here's your money \$25,000. Well what's the next step? Okay well how much is your charge? and he's like, "Hey, this is going to be a thousand I mean, yeah, \$100,000." Like, well, we're out because we we can't afford that. So, it's like how you scale it, how you make it affordable to the airports, um, is going to be critical cuz, you know, you're not the only drone company. So, you have to kind of figure out how what sets you apart from from others.

Strvx Robotics: Yeah. So, we could definitely work within your budget. We'll be under We could find out a price that works for the both of us.

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Kenneth Hinkle: Okay.

Strvx Robotics: But, uh, in regards for the demos, I could do like a we could do a quick demo for the airfield, then we do another demo for the masters. For the masters, you want pretty much security. Just drone uh bird's eye security.

Kenneth Hinkle: Yes, sir. That's

Strvx Robotics: Okay. Yeah, that sounds good. Then we do threat detection.

Kenneth Hinkle: it.

Strvx Robotics: It'll float it up to Would you guys have uh drone operators on the ground or would it be like uh typical

Kenneth Hinkle: Um,

Strvx Robotics: security?

Kenneth Hinkle: well, two things. When you said autonomous, I like, hey, well, if they can program it and it does it itself, we don't need any um human interaction, then you know, that's that's perfect. However, we do have um what we call our ARF and even maybe our operate our um our firefighters have some drone operators. So, we could use those guys. Um but if not, even the operation agents we have that will even give them another skill that they have as well.

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Kenneth Hinkle: So, there are many many options.

Strvx Robotics: Okay. Because uh yeah, we could do everything autonomously, but the thing is due to FAA regulations, there has to be at least one person who could operate it. So it won't like they won't operate the drone.

Kenneth Hinkle: Okay.

Strvx Robotics: It still be autonomous. But let's say it detects a guy with a weapon. It will have to float it up and go for human in the loop review.

Kenneth Hinkle: Okay. Hey, another thing and I'm I'm like I said, I get so excited when I especially when when I'm looking at you guys and it's like young people um you're coming up with great ideas uh to in include like a license plate reader for parking lots for airport for the security piece and you know if you guys get in touch you know on security side a lot of airports are coming up with like cameras and stuff like some of this stuff is not needed when you can just have a drone flying sign over and hey, you know, this is a bad guy.

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Kenneth Hinkle: Report it to the marshals or the sheriff or your police department and it's taken care of. You know, that would be a huge win for um uh for the um for the marshalls and I don't think people are really thinking about that aspect of it. Um for the airports, I know they use it for for crime and you know, instead of helicopters, they're using using drones. So again, man, I I see the possibilities and I'm looking forward to your um your demo. Um and then yeah, cuz hey, if it works for me, um you know, I'm sure it's going to work for for all the other

Strvx Robotics: Yep. Yeah,

Kenneth Hinkle: airports.

Strvx Robotics: we appreciate it. So yeah, to reiterate, we'll make the demo like a rough demo, get idea how it look like, then get something more concrete. You can work with your systems, work with your people, and build software that's more integrated with what whatever you guys are building with,

Kenneth Hinkle: Okay.

Strvx Robotics: and we can get it deployed.

Kenneth Hinkle: Okay.

00:15:02

Kenneth Hinkle: Sounds

Strvx Robotics: Yep.

Kenneth Hinkle: good.

Alex Battikha: Quick question on my side. Is there a better way to stay in touch or you want to stick to

Kenneth Hinkle: Yeah. Either way,

Alex Battikha: email?

Kenneth Hinkle: um I can give you my my um my mobile um email, you know, whatever whatever means you mode you want.

Alex Battikha: Okay, sure.

Kenneth Hinkle: So,

Alex Battikha: Yeah, mobile would be great if you could send that over. Um,

Kenneth Hinkle: okay.

Alex Battikha: so we have your phone and email. That would be perfect.

Kenneth Hinkle: Okay, we'll do it to you now if you like if you can you can write it down or

Alex Battikha: Sounds good.

Kenneth Hinkle: whatever.

Alex Battikha: Sure. Yeah.

Kenneth Hinkle: 706 834 7332.

Alex Battikha: Got it. Okay, perfect. All right. Yeah, we really appreciate your time and we'll stay in touch. I'm excited for Thank

Kenneth Hinkle: Yeah, I'm excited. I'm excited for you guys, too. I hope I hope all this works.

Alex Battikha: you.

Kenneth Hinkle: Mhm.

Strvx Robotics: Thank you.

Kenneth Hinkle: Yes, sir.

Strvx Robotics: All right. Have a good day.

Kenneth Hinkle: How about you?

Strvx Robotics: Bye.

Transcription ended after 00:16:01

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